Business Analysis Report: QDB SME Relief Portal

Product: QDB SME Relief Portal **Version**: 1.0 **Date**: March 3, 2026 **Classification**: Confidential — QDB Internal Use Only
Author: ConnectSW Business Analyst Practice **Status**: Final Draft — Ready for PM Handoff

Table of Contents

1. Executive Summary
2. Business Context
3. Stakeholder Analysis
4. Requirements Elicitation
5. Process Analysis
6. Integration Points Analysis
7. Eligibility Criteria Framework
8. Gap Analysis
9. Competitive Analysis
10. Feasibility Assessment
11. Success Metrics
12. Risk Register
13. Recommendations

1. Executive Summary

Qatar Development Bank (QDB) requires a dedicated digital portal to disburse emergency financial relief to Small and Medium Enterprises (SMEs) impacted by the ongoing regional conflict between Iran and Israel. SMEs are facing immediate cash flow pressures — principally salary obligations and commercial rent — that threaten business continuity and employment across Qatar's private sector.

The proposed QDB SME Relief Portal operationalises the National Relief and Guarantee Program (NRGP), transforming a manual, paper-heavy disbursement process into a structured, auditable digital workflow. The portal authenticates applicants via Tawtheeq (Qatar's National Authentication Service), fetches verified company data from MOCI, evaluates eligibility against NRGP criteria, validates salary obligations against WPS data, and routes disbursement requests — automatically for returning NRGP beneficiaries or manually for first-time applicants — into Microsoft Dynamics CRM for QDB case management.

This analysis concludes with a **strong Go recommendation**. The business case is unambiguous: a geopolitical emergency with identifiable SME victims, a pre-existing government relief framework (NRGP), and QDB's existing integration relationships with NAS/MOCI. The primary risks are integration dependency on government APIs, eligibility criteria ambiguity requiring policy clarification, and the time-bounded nature of the relief window. Delivery must be fast — a 6-to-8-week target — and the portal must be designed to sunset gracefully when the relief window closes.

2. Business Context

2.1 Problem Statement

Who experiences it: SMEs registered in Qatar whose operations depend on trade routes, supply chains, or client relationships affected by the Iran-Israel regional conflict. These businesses are generating reduced revenues while facing fixed cost obligations: employee salaries (legally mandated under Qatar's Wage Protection System) and commercial property rents.

What the problem is: SMEs are caught between legal obligations to pay salaries on time (WPS enforcement) and a sudden revenue shortfall caused by an external geopolitical event entirely outside their control. Without emergency financing, these businesses face:

- WPS violations and associated fines from the Ministry of Labor
- Lease defaults and potential eviction from commercial premises
- Staff layoffs, increasing national unemployment pressure
- Business closure, destroying economic value and employment in Qatar

Cost of inaction:

- Each month of delay: estimated hundreds of Qatar-registered SMEs at risk of WPS violation
- WPS fine per violation: QAR 6,000 per employee; for a 50-person SME, this is QAR 300,000 in fines per late salary cycle
- Business closure cascades into unemployment, reduced tax base, and demand pressure on social services
- Reputational risk to QDB: the National Relief and Guarantee Program exists; failure to operationalise it quickly undermines institutional credibility

Why a digital portal is the right solution: QDB cannot scale a manual paper-based review process fast enough to reach thousands of SMEs before irreversible harm occurs. A structured digital portal with automated eligibility checking, WPS integration, and CRM routing eliminates the bottleneck while maintaining auditability and fraud controls.

2.2 Market Landscape

Qatar SME Ecosystem:

Metric	Figure	Source
Total registered SMEs in Qatar	~40,000	MOCI 2025 estimates
SME contribution to private sector employment	~40%	QDB Economic Research
SMEs in trade, import/export, logistics (most exposed)	~8,000–12,000	MOCI sector data
SMEs in retail/hospitality (secondary exposure)	~6,000–9,000	MOCI sector data
SMEs previously on NRGP beneficiary list	~2,000–4,000	QDB NRGP program data
Average monthly salary obligation (50-person SME)	QAR 250,000–500,000	WPS aggregate data
Average monthly rent obligation (commercial, mid-size)	QAR 30,000–80,000	Real estate market data

Geopolitical Context: The Iran-Israel conflict creates indirect disruption to Qatar's SME ecosystem through: trade route uncertainty affecting imports through the Strait of Hormuz, energy price volatility affecting operating costs, travel restriction impact on tourism-dependent businesses, and regional supply chain fragmentation for manufacturing and retail SMEs. Qatar itself is not a direct party to the conflict, but geographic proximity and trade relationships create real and demonstrable economic impact.

NRGP Program Context: The National Relief and Guarantee Program is an existing QDB instrument established to provide emergency financing backstops during periods of economic stress. Previous activations include the COVID-19 period. The program has:

- An existing beneficiary list (companies that qualified and received relief previously)
- Pre-negotiated terms and guarantee structures
- Regulatory and board-level approval as a standing program
- Established QDB operational procedures (currently manual)

The existence of the NRGP means QDB is not creating a new financial product — it is digitising delivery of an approved, existing product under an emergency activation mandate.

2.3 Target Segments

Primary Segment — Directly Impacted SMEs:

- SMEs in import/export, logistics, freight, and trade (direct supply chain disruption)
- SMEs in tourism, hospitality, events (regional travel disruption)
- SMEs with Iran-linked commercial relationships (direct trade exposure)
- Size: estimated 8,000–12,000 businesses; eligible subset: 2,000–5,000 after criteria

Secondary Segment — Indirectly Impacted SMEs:

- SMEs in retail with import dependencies on affected supply chains
- SMEs in services with clients who are directly impacted
- Size: estimated 4,000–8,000 businesses; smaller eligible subset

Excluded Segments (not served by this portal):

- Large enterprises (above SME threshold per QDB definition)
- Sole proprietors with no registered employees (no WPS obligation)
- SMEs in sectors with no demonstrable geopolitical impact
- Foreign companies without Qatar CR registration

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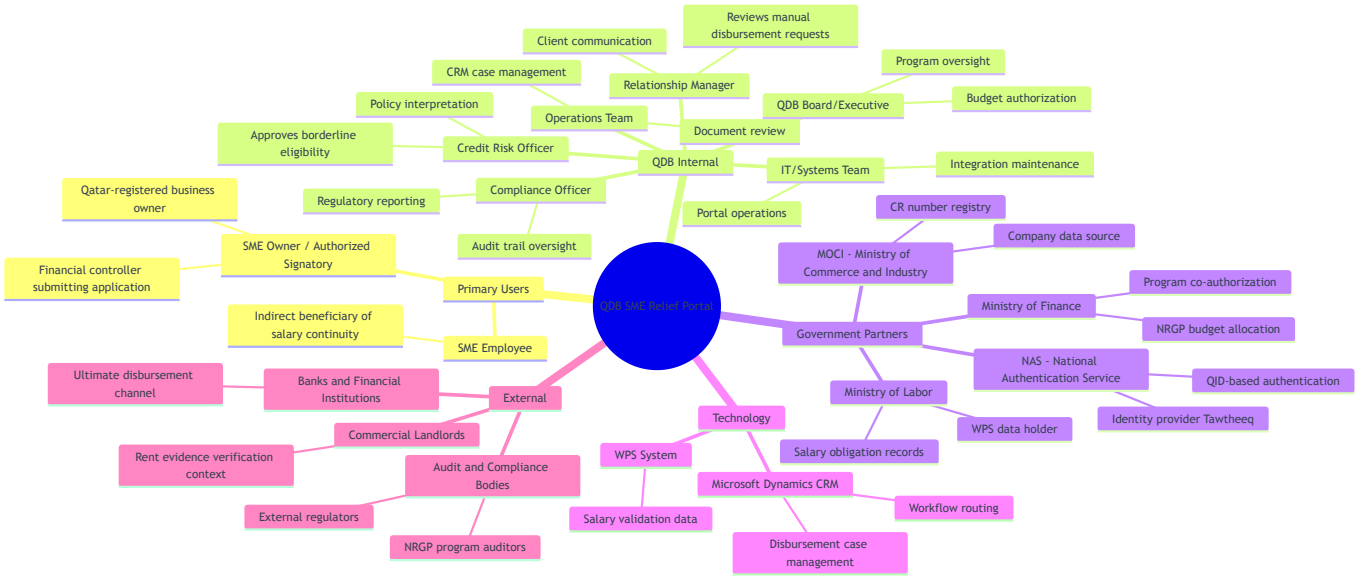
3. Stakeholder Analysis

3.1 Stakeholder Map

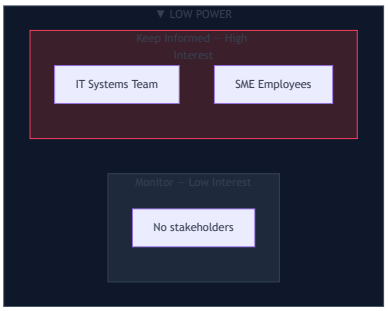


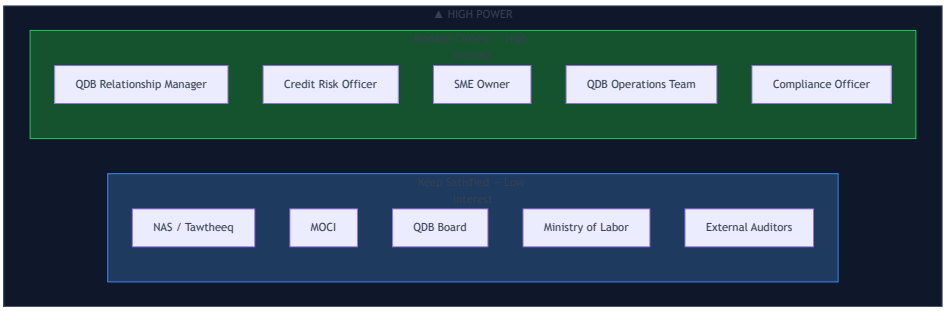
3.2 Stakeholder Register

Stakeholder	Role	Interest Level	Influence Level	Primary Needs	Communication Channel
SME Owner/Signatory	Primary applicant	High	High	Fast approval, clear status, minimal documents	Portal notifications, email, SMS
QDB Relationship Manager	Internal reviewer (manual cases)	High	High	Clear case information, decision support tools	CRM dashboard, email
QDB Credit Risk Officer	Policy interpreter	Medium	High	Eligibility rule clarity, borderline guidance	Internal systems, policy docs
QDB Compliance Officer	Audit and regulatory	High	Medium	Complete audit trail, NRGP compliance evidence	Audit reports, CRM
QDB Operations Team	Day-to-day case management	High	Medium	Efficient workflow, minimal manual steps	CRM, operational dashboards
NAS/Tawtheeq	Authentication provider	Low	Critical	Correct SAML/OIDC integration, no misuse	API integration
MOCI	Company data provider	Low	Critical	Correct CR query API usage, data accuracy	API integration
Ministry of Labor/WPS	Salary data provider	Low	High	Correct WPS file query, data protection	API/file integration
QDB Board	Program owner	Low (day-to-day)	Critical	Program success, fiduciary responsibility	Executive reports

Stakeholder	Role	Interest Level	Influence Level	Primary Needs	Communication Channel
External Auditors	Compliance verification	Low	Medium	Complete, tamper-evident audit records	Audit exports

3.3 Power/Interest Grid





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4. Requirements Elicitation

4.1 Business Needs

ID	Need	Source	Priority	Rationale
BN-001	SMEs must be able to authenticate using their existing Tawtheeq/NAS credentials without creating a new QDB account	CEO Brief	P0	NAS provides verified Qatari identity; no new credential store needed; consistent with QDB One strategy
BN-002	The portal must retrieve verified company data from MOCI using the CR number so applicants cannot self-report company information	CEO Brief	P0	MOCI data is authoritative; prevents fraudulent company details; eliminates manual verification of company identity
BN-003	The system must evaluate SME eligibility against NRGP criteria automatically and communicate the result to the applicant	CEO Brief	P0	Manual eligibility review cannot scale to thousands of applications within the relief window
BN-004	Disbursement requests for companies on the existing NRGP beneficiary list must be created automatically in Dynamics CRM without manual QDB intervention	CEO Brief	P0	Previous NRGP beneficiaries are pre-vetted; auto-routing eliminates queue bottleneck for known-good applicants
BN-005	Disbursement requests for companies NOT on the NRGP list must land in Dynamics CRM as a manual review case with full supporting information	CEO Brief	P0	New applicants require QDB relationship manager review before commitment; CRM is the case management system of record
BN-006	Applicants must be able to upload salary payment evidence, rent payment evidence, and company documents	CEO Brief	P0	Document evidence is required to substantiate financial impact claim and satisfy NRGP audit requirements
BN-007	Salary obligations must be validated against WPS (Wage Protection System) data to verify the amount and regularity of payroll	CEO Brief	P0	WPS is the Ministry of Labor's authoritative record; prevents inflated salary claims; ensures relief quantum is evidence-based
BN-008	Every application must produce a complete, tamper-evident audit trail capturing each process step, decision, data source, and actor	Compliance	P0	NRGP program is subject to government audit; QDB is the custodian of public relief

ID	Need	Source	Priority	Rationale
				funds; auditability is non-negotiable
BN-009	The portal must display clear application status to the SME applicant throughout the process	Product Quality	P1	Applicants need to know where they stand; reduces support call volume; builds trust in the process
BN-010	The portal must be available in Arabic and English	Regulatory / User Need	P1	Qatar's business community operates in both languages; Arabic is the official language; accessibility requirement
BN-011	The portal must enforce document format validation (file type, size, completeness) at upload time to prevent incomplete submissions	Process Quality	P1	Incomplete document packs are the primary cause of case delay; early validation reduces re-work
BN-012	The portal must communicate application outcomes to the SME via email and/or SMS notification	User Need	P1	Applicants may not poll the portal; proactive communication reduces anxiety and support load
BN-013	QDB operations staff must be able to access a management dashboard showing application volumes, statuses, and processing timelines	Operational Need	P1	Without visibility, QDB cannot manage capacity, identify bottlenecks, or report program status to the board
BN-014	The portal must handle concurrent high-volume submissions without degradation during the application launch window	Technical Requirement	P1	Program announcement will trigger a submission spike; system must not collapse under load
BN-015	The portal must close gracefully at the end of the relief window, preventing new submissions after the program end date without breaking in-progress cases	Program Lifecycle	P2	NRGP activations are time-bound; the portal must have a defined lifecycle, not run indefinitely
BN-016	QDB must be able to configure eligibility criteria in the portal without a code deployment	Operational Flexibility	P2	Policy teams may adjust criteria as the program evolves; deployment-free configuration reduces time-to-change

ID	Need	Source	Priority	Rationale
BN-017	The portal must detect and prevent duplicate applications from the same CR number	Fraud Control	P2	Prevents the same company from submitting multiple applications for the same relief period
BN-018	Document storage must be encrypted at rest and access-controlled so only authorized QDB staff and the applicant can access uploaded files	Security / Compliance	P1	Documents contain commercially sensitive and personally identifiable information; PDPA compliance

4.2 Business Rules

ID	Rule	Source	Impact
BR-001	A company must have a valid, active Commercial Registration (CR) in Qatar to be eligible	NRGP Policy	Filters out dissolved, suspended, or foreign-registered entities
BR-002	A company must have active employees enrolled in WPS to receive salary relief	NRGP Policy	Confirms employment relationship; excludes sole traders without payroll
BR-003	The relief quantum for salaries cannot exceed the WPS-validated payroll figure for the last three months	NRGP Policy	Prevents over-claiming; anchors to verifiable government data
BR-004	A company on the NRGP beneficiary list is auto-disbursed without additional eligibility review	QDB Decision (CEO Brief)	Reduces processing time for pre-vetted companies
BR-005	A company NOT on the NRGP beneficiary list requires a manual QDB relationship manager review before disbursement	QDB Decision (CEO Brief)	Applies appropriate scrutiny to new applicants
BR-006	Only the CR-registered owner or an authorized signatory (as recorded at MOCI) may submit an application	Regulatory / Fraud Control	Ensures legal authority to bind the company to a financing agreement
BR-007	One active application per CR number per relief period is permitted	Fraud Control	Prevents duplicate disbursements to the same legal entity
BR-008	All uploaded documents must be retained for a minimum of 7 years in accordance with QDB record retention policy	Compliance	Drives document storage architecture and lifecycle policy
BR-009	Applications submitted after the program end date must be rejected with a clear communication to the applicant	Program Lifecycle	Defines behavior at program close
BR-010	WPS validation must query data no older than 90 days	Data Freshness	Ensures salary relief is based on current, not historical, payroll

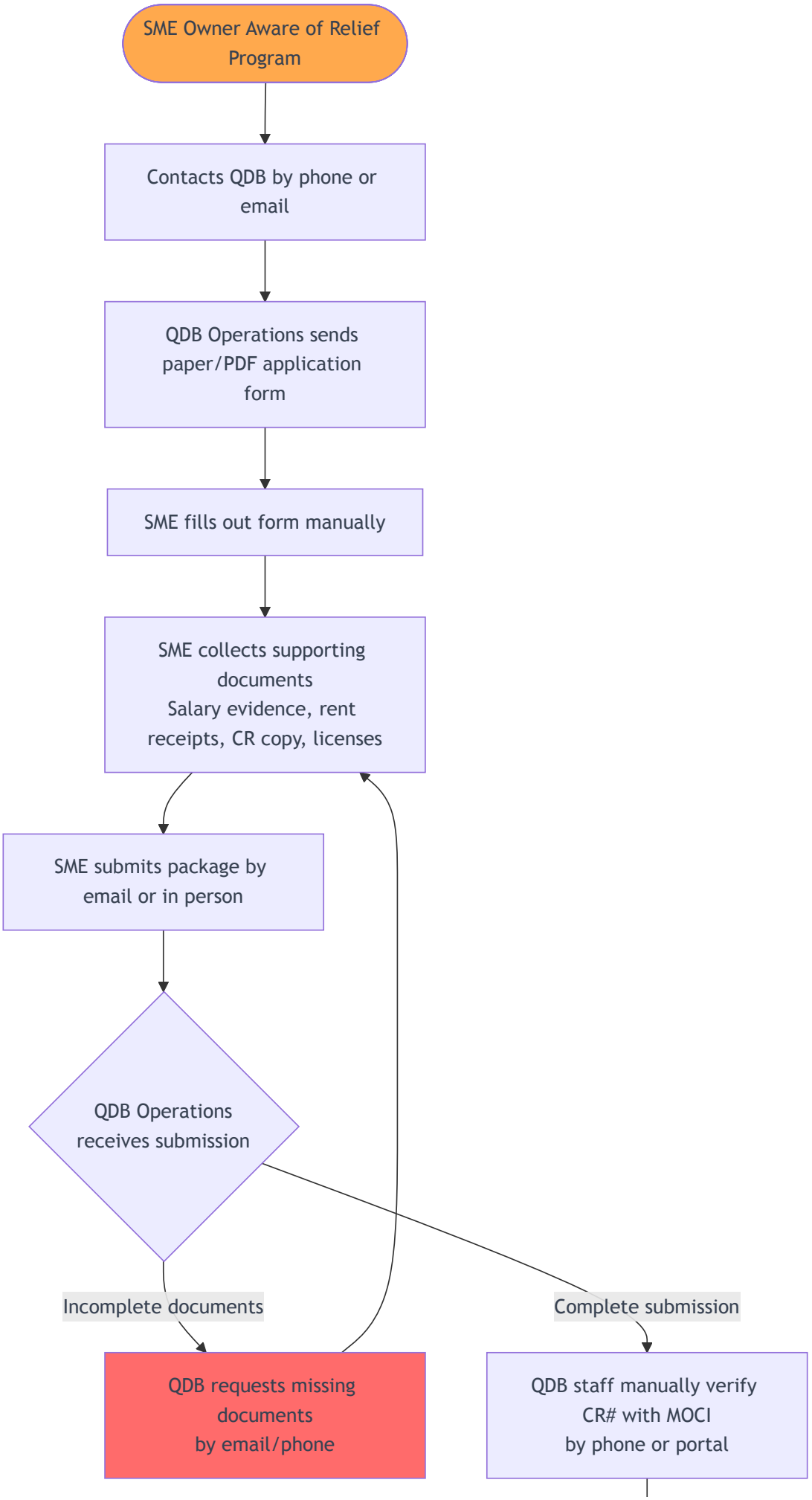
4.3 Assumptions

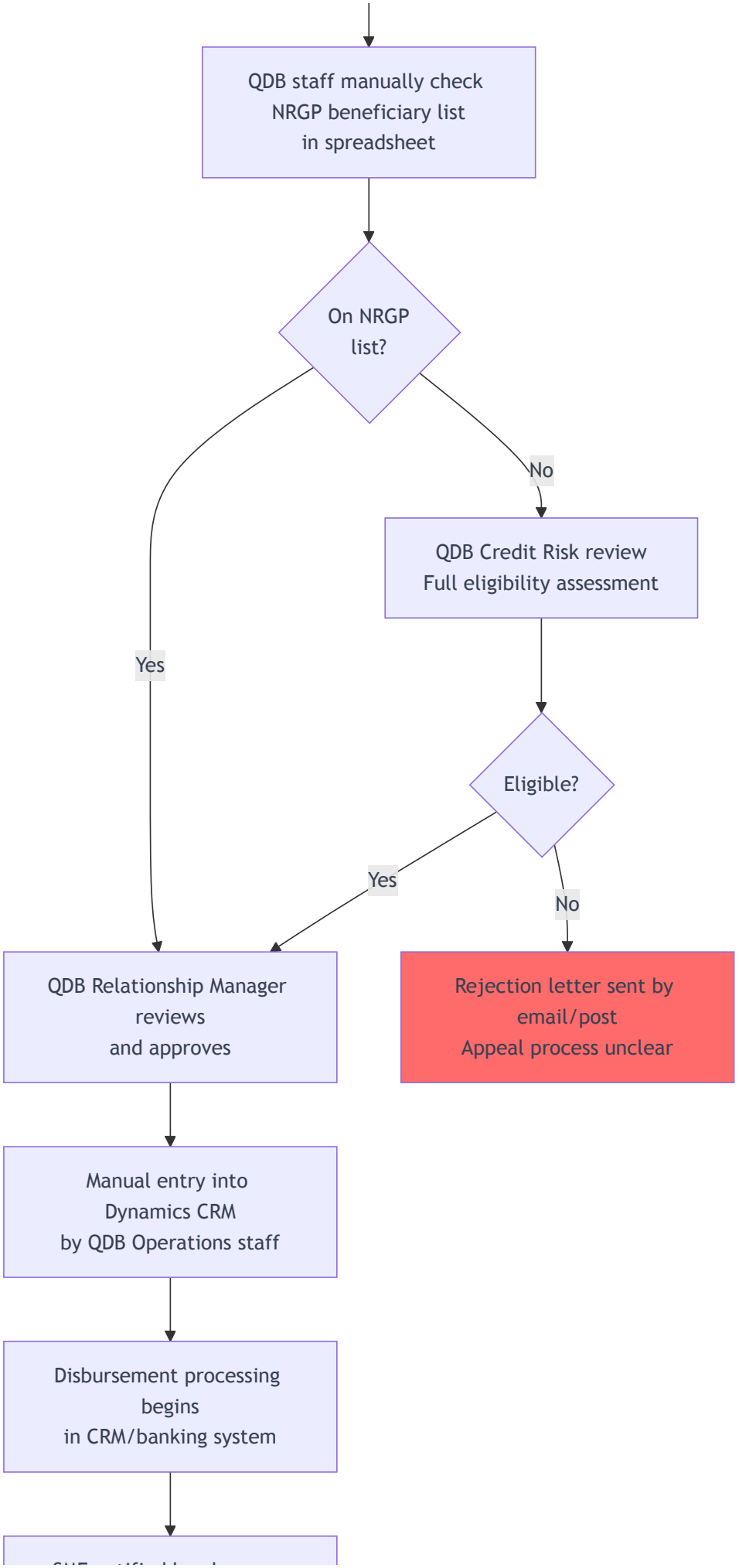
ID	Assumption	Risk if Wrong	Validation Plan
ASM-001	NAS/Tawtheeq provides a usable OIDC or SAML 2.0 API that QDB can integrate with for this portal, consistent with the QDB One architecture	Portal cannot authenticate users; entire product is blocked	Confirm with NAS integration team within Sprint 0; review QDB One ADR-002 for existing agreement
ASM-002	MOCI provides a REST or SOAP API for CR number lookup that returns company name, status, sector, and registered shareholders in real time or near-real time	Company data must be entered manually, introducing fraud risk and slowing the process	Confirm MOCI API availability and SLA with QDB IT within Sprint 0
ASM-003	The Ministry of Labor / WPS provides an API or file-based data feed that can be queried by QDB with company CR number to return payroll data	WPS validation step cannot be automated; salary amounts must be taken from uploaded documents only	Confirm WPS integration mechanism with Ministry of Labor and QDB IT within Sprint 0
ASM-004	Microsoft Dynamics CRM is accessible via a documented REST API that allows creation and updating of disbursement case records programmatically	Case routing to CRM is manual; breaks the core portal workflow	Confirm Dynamics CRM API endpoint and authentication method with QDB IT within Sprint 0
ASM-005	QDB has an existing and current NRGP beneficiary list in a structured format (database or exportable file) that can be loaded into the portal for lookup	NRGP list check cannot be automated; all applications become manual review	Confirm list availability and format with QDB Operations within Sprint 0
ASM-006	The NRGP eligibility criteria are documented, agreed, and stable at product launch	Eligibility engine cannot be built; frequent criteria changes during launch create re-work	Obtain written eligibility criteria sign-off from QDB Credit Risk and Compliance before Sprint 1 ends
ASM-007	SME owners or their authorized signatories have Tawtheeq accounts and can authenticate via NAS	A significant proportion of target users cannot log in, requiring an alternative authentication path	Survey a sample of target SME contacts; if >20% lack Tawtheeq, an alternative path must be designed
ASM-008	QDB has authority to process WPS data from the Ministry of Labor for	Legal/regulatory block on WPS integration; data	Legal counsel confirms data sharing agreement or

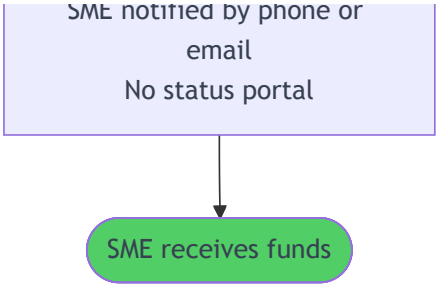
ID	Assumption	Risk if Wrong	Validation Plan
	the purpose of relief disbursement	cannot be used	MOU between QDB and Ministry of Labor before sprint planning
ASM-009	The portal is required for a defined, finite relief window (estimated 3–6 months) after which applications close	If the window is undefined, the portal becomes a permanent product requiring full lifecycle support	QDB program team confirms start and end dates before Sprint 0 completes
ASM-010	Document uploads will be reviewed by QDB staff via Dynamics CRM or an integrated document viewer; the portal does not need to display documents to reviewers directly	If CRM cannot surface documents, a separate reviewer interface must be built, increasing scope	Confirm CRM document display capability with QDB IT within Sprint 0

5. Process Analysis

5.1 Current State (As-Is) — Manual NRGP Process


SME Owner Aware of Relief Program
Contacts QDB by phone or email
QDB Operations sends paper/PDF application form
SME fills out form manually
SME collects supporting documents
Salary evidence, rent receipts, CR copy, licenses
SME submits package by email or in person
QDB Operations receives submission
Incomplete documents
Complete submission
QDB requests missing documents
by email/phone
QDB staff manually verify CR# with MOCI
by phone or portal

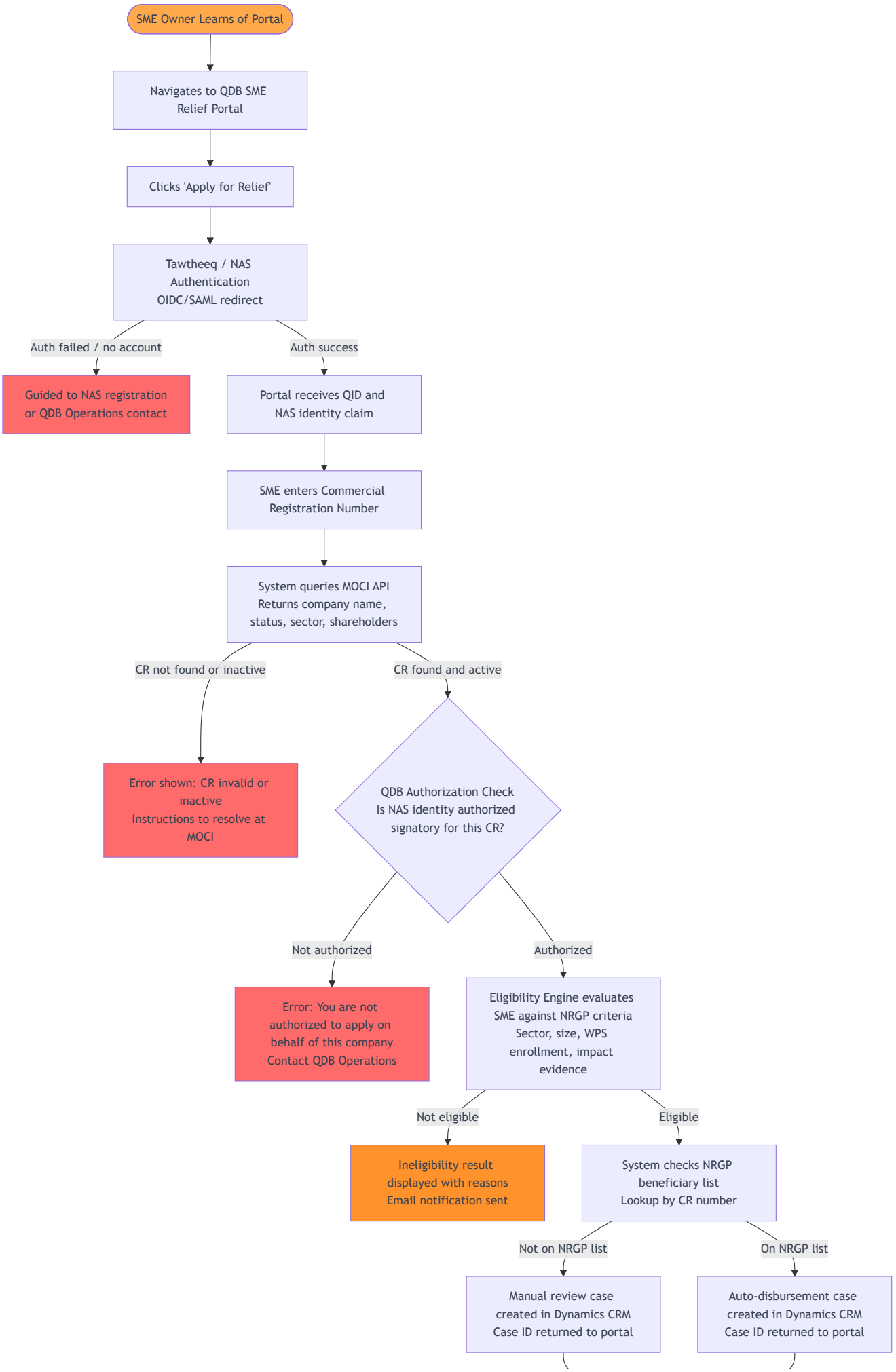

QDB staff manually check
NRGP beneficiary list
in spreadsheet
On NRGP
list?
No
Yes
QDB Credit Risk review
Full eligibility assessment
Eligible?
Yes
No
QDB Relationship Manager
reviews
and approves
Rejection letter sent by
email/post
Appeal process unclear
Manual entry into
Dynamics CRM
by QDB Operations staff
Disbursement processing
begins
in CRM/banking system

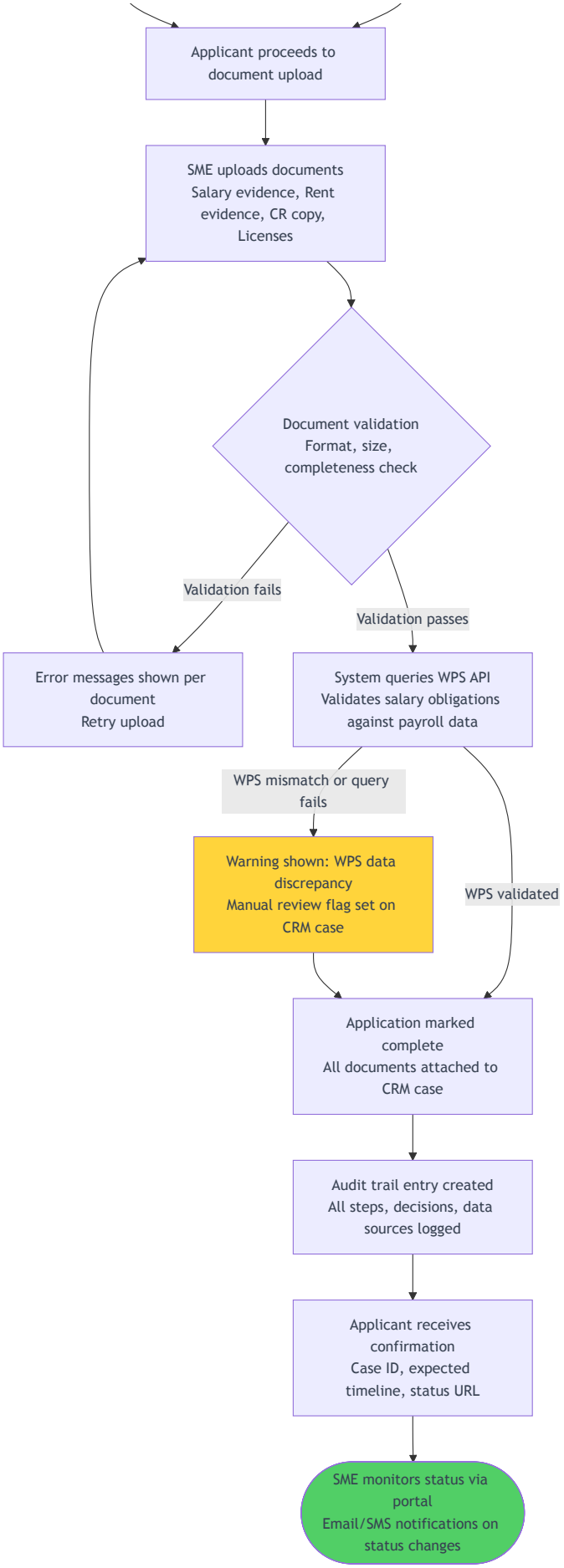


As-Is Pain Points:

- Average processing time: 15–30 business days (estimated)
- Document re-submission rate: estimated 40–60% due to incomplete initial packs
- No real-time status visibility for SME
- MOCI verification is manual and inconsistent
- NRGP list check is manual (spreadsheet); prone to error and version control issues
- CRM entry is double-keyed (form data re-entered by operations staff)
- No fraud detection on duplicate applications
- No automated WPS validation; salary figures taken on trust from applicant
- Audit trail exists only in paper/email records; not structured or searchable

5.2 Future State (To-Be) — QDB SME Relief Portal


SME Owner Learns of Portal
Navigates to QDB SME Relief Portal
Clicks 'Apply for Relief'
Tawtheeq / NAS Authentication OIDC/SAML redirect
Auth failed / no account
Auth success
Guided to NAS registration or QDB Operations contact
Portal receives QID and NAS identity claim
SME enters Commercial Registration Number
System queries MOCI API Returns company name, status, sector, shareholders
CR not found or inactive
CR found and active
Error shown: CR invalid or inactive Instructions to resolve at MOCI
QDB Authorization Check Is NAS identity authorized signatory for this CR?
Not authorized
Authorized
Error: You are not authorized to apply on behalf of this company Contact QDB Operations
Eligibility Engine evaluates SME against NRGP criteria Sector, size, WPS enrollment, impact evidence
Not eligible
Eligible
Ineligibility result displayed with reasons Email notification sent
System checks NRGP beneficiary list Lookup by CR number
Not on NRGP list
On NRGP list
Manual review case created in Dynamics CRM Case ID returned to portal
Auto-disbursement case created in Dynamics CRM Case ID returned to portal

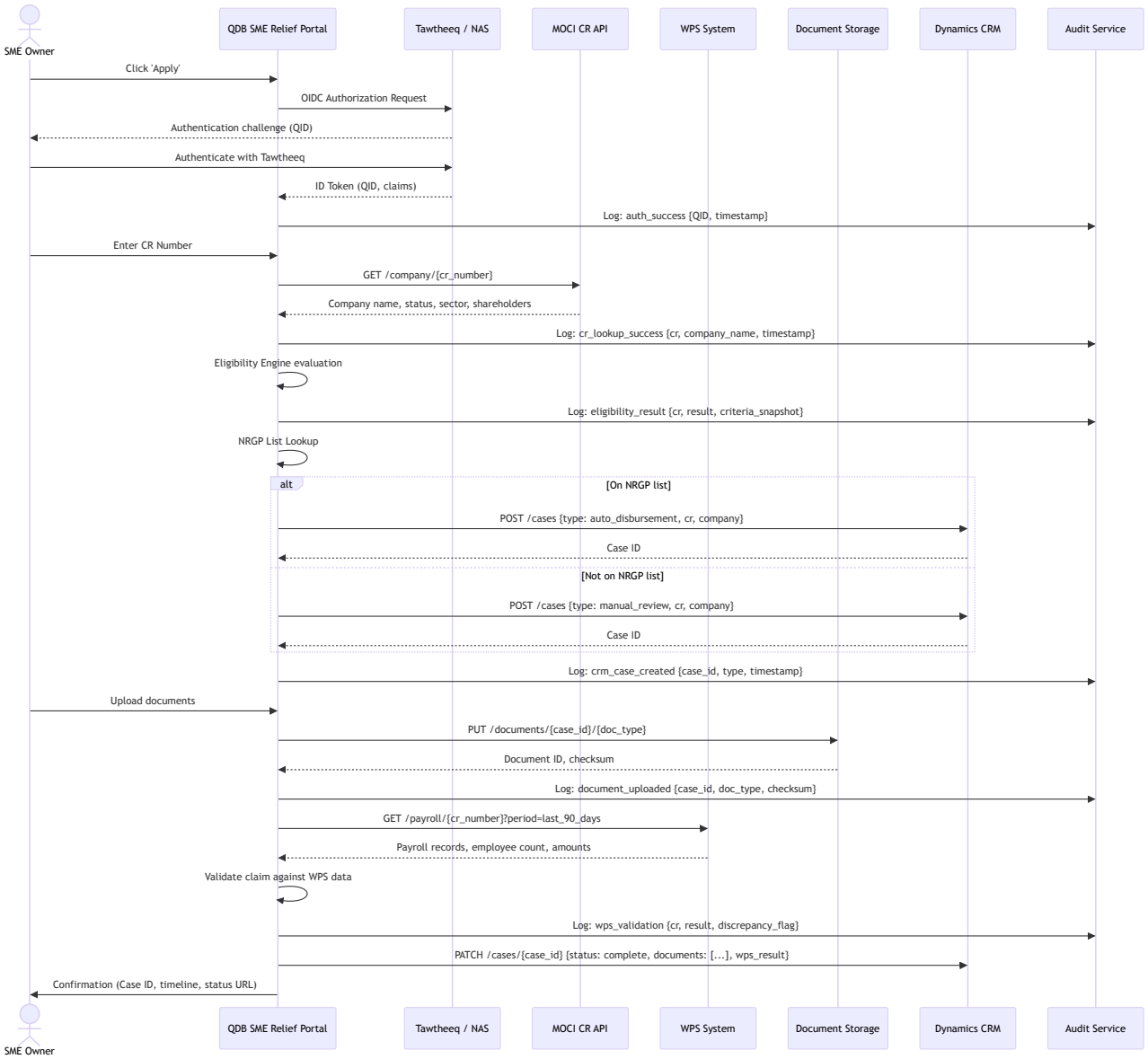


5.3 Process Improvement Quantification

Metric	As-Is (Manual)	To-Be (Portal)	Improvement
Application processing time	15–30 business days	1–3 business days (auto) / 5–10 days (manual review)	70–85% reduction
Document re-submission rate	40–60%	<10% (validation at upload)	50-point reduction
MOCI verification time	1–2 days (manual)	<5 seconds (API)	99% reduction
NRGP list check time	Hours to days (spreadsheet)	<1 second (database)	100% automated
CRM entry error rate	~15% (double-key entry)	0% (API-written)	Eliminated
Audit trail completeness	Partial (email/paper)	100% structured and searchable	Full compliance
Applicant status visibility	None	Real-time	New capability
Duplicate application detection	None	Automated (CR-level dedup)	New capability

6. Integration Points Analysis

6.1 Integration Architecture Overview



6.2 Tawtheeq / NAS Authentication Integration

Attribute	Detail
Protocol	OIDC (preferred) or SAML 2.0
Identity Claim	QID (Qatar Identification Number)
Assurance Level	NAS Level 2 (minimum); request Level 3 if available for financial applications
Session Management	Portal issues its own JWT session after NAS assertion; NAS session not maintained
Established Pattern	QDB One ADR-002: NAS via Keycloak gateway, SAML 2.0/OIDC, custom post-login QID mapper
Key Risk	NAS availability is a single point of failure for authentication; no alternative login path for QID holders
Fallback	Display "NAS temporarily unavailable — try again in 30 minutes" with QDB Operations contact
Data Retained	QID only (not password or credentials); NAS manages credential security
Reference	QDB One ADR-002-authentication.md

6.3 MOCI CR Number Lookup Integration

Attribute	Detail
Protocol	REST API (JSON) or SOAP (XML) — confirm with MOCI
Query Parameter	CR number (10-digit format)
Expected Response	Company name (Arabic + English), CR status (active/inactive/suspended), registration date, sector classification, authorized signatories / shareholders
Latency Requirement	<3 seconds (user-facing step; must be fast)
Error Handling	CR not found → display error, link to MOCI; MOCI API unavailable → display error, log incident, do not allow manual entry
Cache Strategy	Cache company data for current session only; do not persist beyond application submission (data accuracy)
Authorization Check	Cross-reference NAS-provided QID with MOCI-provided shareholder/signatory list to verify the applicant has authority to apply
Key Risk	MOCI API may not have real-time shareholder data; authorization check may have gaps

6.4 WPS (Wage Protection System) Integration

Attribute	Detail
Protocol	API or file-based data feed — confirm with Ministry of Labor
Query Key	CR number
Data Returned	Employee count, total monthly payroll (last 90 days), per-month breakdown, payment dates
Validation Logic	Compare claimed salary relief amount to WPS payroll figure; flag discrepancies >10% as manual review
Data Age Limit	WPS data must be no older than 90 days (BR-010)
Legal Basis	Data sharing MOU between QDB and Ministry of Labor must be confirmed (ASM-008)
Failure Mode	If WPS query fails → flag application for manual salary verification; do not block submission
Key Risk	WPS API may not exist; data may be available only via secure file transfer; integration may require MOU not yet in place

6.5 Microsoft Dynamics CRM Integration

Attribute	Detail
Protocol	Dynamics 365 Web API (REST/OData)
Authentication	OAuth 2.0 with Azure AD service principal
Case Creation — Auto	Entity: `qdb_disbursement_case`; type field: `auto_nrgp`; status: `pending_disbursement`
Case Creation — Manual	Entity: `qdb_disbursement_case`; type field: `manual_review`; status: `pending_review`
Document Attachment	Documents linked to CRM case by URL reference to document storage (not embedded in CRM)
WPS Validation Result	Attached as a structured note on the CRM case
Case ID	Returned to portal immediately on creation; displayed to applicant as tracking reference
Status Updates	CRM updates case status → portal reads status for applicant-facing display (polling or webhook)
Key Risk	Dynamics CRM schema may require customisation; CRM API access may require IT change management approval

6.6 Document Storage

Attribute	Detail
Storage Type	Secure object storage (Azure Blob Storage or equivalent on-premise)
Naming Convention	`{case_id}/{doc_type}/{timestamp}_{original_filename}`
Accepted Formats	PDF, JPEG, PNG, TIFF (for scanned documents)
Max File Size	10 MB per document, 50 MB per application package
Encryption	AES-256 at rest; TLS 1.3 in transit
Access Control	Applicant: upload only, read own documents. QDB Staff: read via CRM link. Audit: immutable read
Retention Policy	7 years minimum (BR-008)
Document Types	Salary payment evidence, rent payment evidence, commercial registration copy, business licenses, additional impact evidence
Virus Scanning	All uploads scanned before storage

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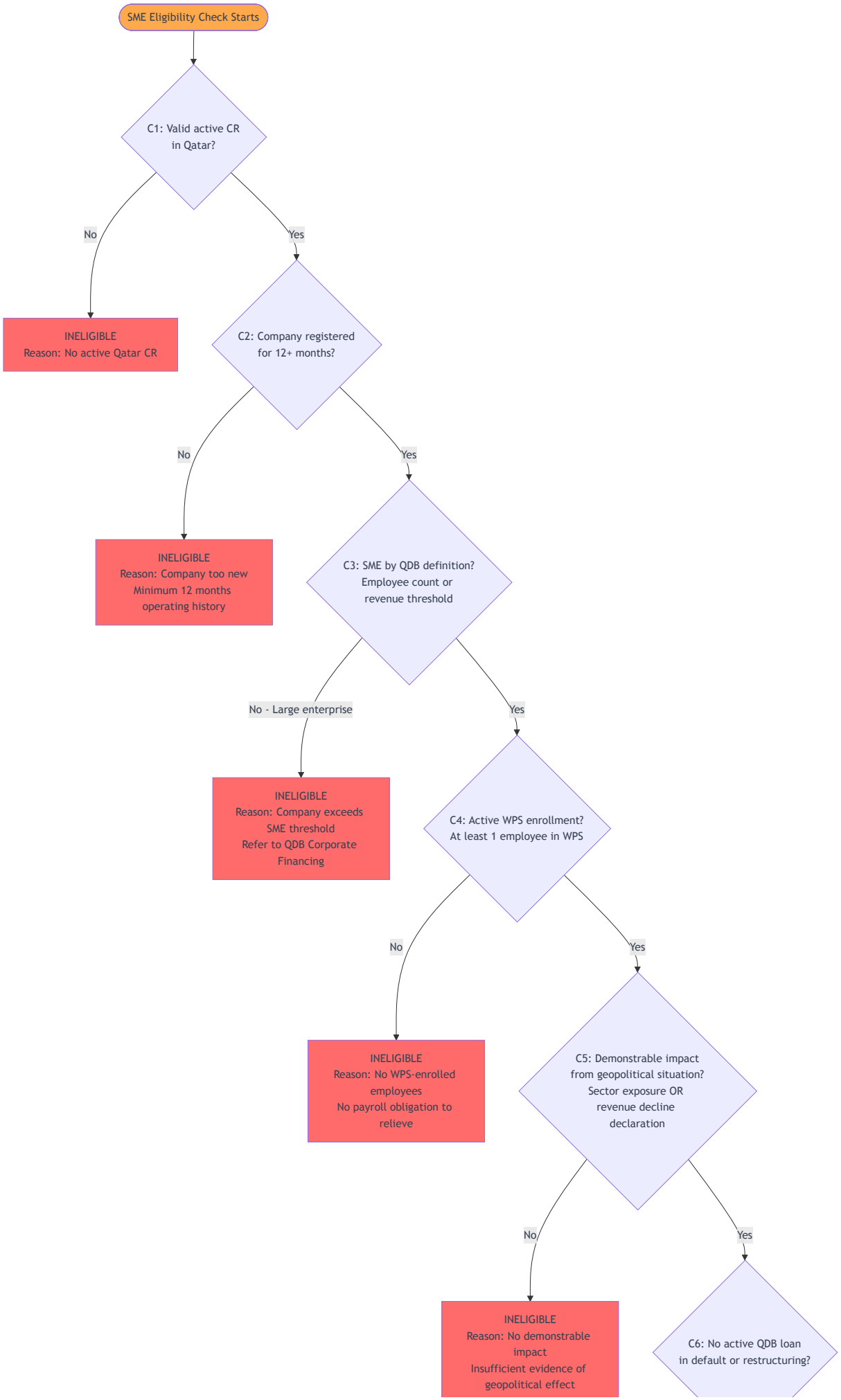
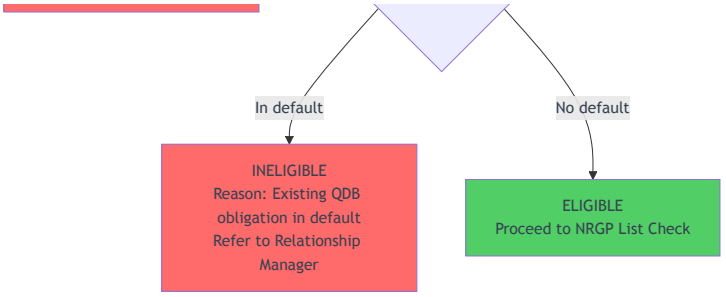
7. Eligibility Criteria Framework

7.1 Eligibility Criteria Definition

The following criteria define whether an SME qualifies for NRGP relief. These criteria require written sign-off from QDB Credit Risk and Compliance (ASM-006) before implementation.


SME Eligibility Check Starts
C1: Valid active CR in Qatar?
No
Yes
INELIGIBLE Reason: No active Qatar CR
C2: Company registered for 12+ months?
No
Yes
INELIGIBLE Reason: Company too new Minimum 12 months operating history
C3: SME by QDB definition? Employee count or revenue threshold
No - Large enterprise
Yes
INELIGIBLE Reason: Company exceeds SME threshold Refer to QDB Corporate Financing
C4: Active WPS enrollment? At least 1 employee in WPS
No
Yes
INELIGIBLE Reason: No WPS-enrolled employees No payroll obligation to relieve
C5: Demonstrable impact from geopolitical situation? Sector exposure OR revenue decline declaration
No
Yes
INELIGIBLE Reason: No demonstrable impact Insufficient evidence of geopolitical effect
C6: No active QDB loan in default or restructuring?



7.2 Eligibility Criteria Register

Criterion ID	Criterion	Data Source	Automated?	Notes
EC-001	Valid active Commercial Registration in Qatar	MOCI API	Yes	CR status field must be "active"
EC-002	Company registered for minimum 12 months	MOCI API (registration date)	Yes	Registration date >12 months before application date
EC-003	SME classification by QDB definition	MOCI (employee count) + applicant declaration	Partial	QDB defines SME as <100 employees or <QAR 30M revenue; verify with QDB policy
EC-004	Minimum 1 employee enrolled in WPS	WPS API	Yes	Employee count >0 in WPS records
EC-005	Operates in an impacted sector OR declares >X% revenue decline	Sector classification (MOCI) + applicant declaration	Partial	Impacted sector list defined by QDB; revenue decline requires declaration and supporting evidence
EC-006	No active QDB financing in default or restructuring	QDB internal CRM/loan system	Yes	Requires internal QDB system integration or manual check flag
EC-007	Not currently under judicial dissolution or bankruptcy proceedings	MOCI API (company status)	Yes	CR status check covers this if MOCI marks dissolved companies

7.3 Relief Quantum Calculation

Relief Type	Calculation Basis	Cap	Source
Salary Relief	WPS-validated payroll for last 3 months	QAR [TBD by QDB policy] per employee per month	WPS + NRGP policy
Rent Relief	Rent evidence (lease agreement + payment proof)	QAR [TBD by QDB policy] per month	Supporting documents + NRGP policy
Combined Cap	Total relief per application	QAR [TBD by QDB policy]	NRGP program budget allocation

Note: Specific cap figures require QDB Credit Risk sign-off. These are placeholders pending policy confirmation.

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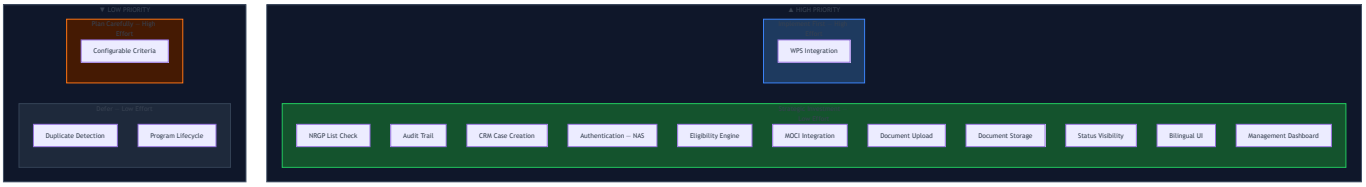
8. Gap Analysis

8.1 Capability Gap Matrix

Capability	Current State	Desired State	Gap	Priority	Effort
SME Authentication	No digital authentication for relief applications; manual identity verification	NAS/Tawtheeq OIDC authentication with QID-based identity	High — full gap	P0	M
Company Data Lookup	Manual MOCI check by QDB staff; paper CR copies from applicant	Automated MOCI API integration returning verified company data	High — full gap	P0	M
Eligibility Evaluation	Manual review by Credit Risk officer; inconsistent and slow	Rules-based eligibility engine with configurable criteria	High — full gap	P0	M
NRGP List Check	Manual spreadsheet lookup by operations staff	Database lookup against structured NRGP beneficiary list	High — full gap	P0	S
CRM Case Creation	Manual double-key data entry by operations staff	Automated API-driven case creation in Dynamics CRM	High — full gap	P0	M
Document Collection	Email submission or in-person; no validation	Structured online upload with format/completeness validation	High — full gap	P0	M
WPS Salary Validation	No validation; figures taken from applicant declaration	Automated WPS API query and cross-validation	High — full gap	P0	L
Audit Trail	Partial; email and paper records only	Complete, structured, tamper-evident digital audit log	High — full gap	P0	S
Applicant Status Visibility	No self-service status; phone/email enquiries only	Real-time status display in portal + notifications	Medium — full gap	P1	S
Bilingual Support	English-only portal (if any digital exists)	Full Arabic and English UI	Medium — full gap	P1	M
Document Storage	Email attachments; no structured	Encrypted, access-controlled document store	High — full gap	P1	S

Capability	Current State	Desired State	Gap	Priority	Effort
	storage	linked to CRM			
Duplicate Detection	None	CR-level deduplication per relief period	Medium — full gap	P2	S
Management Dashboard	None	Application volume, status, processing time dashboard	Medium — full gap	P1	M
Configurable Criteria	Hardcoded in manual process	Admin-configurable eligibility criteria	Low — full gap	P2	L
Program Lifecycle Management	Manual; no defined close procedure	Automated program end date enforcement with graceful close	Low — partial gap	P2	S

8.2 Gap Visualization



Reading the chart: WPS Integration is the only P0 capability with high effort — it requires government API negotiation and data sharing agreements. All other P0 items are medium-to-low effort individually. The project's critical path runs through WPS and CRM integration confirmation.

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9. Competitive Analysis

9.1 Context: Comparable Government Relief Portal Programs

This is a government-mandated emergency relief program; there is no direct commercial competitor. The relevant comparisons are other government emergency relief portals deployed in response to geopolitical or economic disruption.

Program	Country	Year	Authentication	Processing Time	Key Feature	Weakness
COVID-19 SBA PPP Portal	USA	2020	IRS/banking credentials	5–10 days (auto)	Bank-integrated auto disbursement	Fraud losses ($80B+); weak identity verification
COVID-19 CBILS (UK)	UK	2020	HMRC credentials (GOV.UK Verify)	5–10 business days	Accredited lender network	Lender inconsistency; applicant confusion
Qatar NRGP (Manual, COVID)	Qatar	2020–21	Manual; paper-based	15–30 days	Existing NRGP framework	Speed; no digital portal
UAE Economic Relief Portal	UAE	2020	UAE Pass (national ID)	3–7 days	UAE Pass integration (NAS equivalent)	Limited SME-specific tools
Saudi Arabia KAFALAH SME Support	KSA	2020–22	Absher (national ID)	7–14 days	Integration with Absher identity	Coverage limited to banked SMEs

9.2 Feature Comparison Matrix

Feature	QDB SME Relief Portal (Proposed)	Typical Government Relief Portal	UAE Economic Relief	Saudi KAFALAH
National ID Authentication	Yes (NAS/Tawtheeq)	Varies	Yes (UAE Pass)	Yes (Absher)
Company Registry Integration	Yes (MOCI)	Rarely automated	Partial	Partial
Payroll/Wage System Validation	Yes (WPS)	Rarely	No	Partial (GOSI)
Auto-disbursement for pre-vetted	Yes (NRGP list)	No	No	No
CRM-integrated case management	Yes (Dynamics)	Varies	No	No
Bilingual (Arabic/English)	Yes	Arabic-only common	Yes	Arabic primary
Structured audit trail	Yes	Varies	Partial	Partial
Real-time applicant status	Yes	Rarely	Partial	Partial

9.3 Competitive Positioning

The QDB SME Relief Portal, as specified, is materially more sophisticated than comparable emergency relief portals because it integrates:

- Government identity (NAS) for fraud prevention
- Company registry (MOCI) for verified company data — eliminating self-reported fraud
- Wage protection data (WPS) for salary quantum validation — a unique capability
- Pre-vetted beneficiary auto-routing — reducing processing time to near-zero for ~30–40% of applicants

The primary differentiator risk is WPS integration. If WPS cannot be integrated in time, the salary validation advantage is lost and the portal falls back to document-based salary verification (a significant downgrade in fraud control and processing efficiency).

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10. Feasibility Assessment

10.1 Technical Feasibility

Stack Alignment: The proposed portal uses ConnectSW's default stack (Next.js frontend, Fastify backend, PostgreSQL, Prisma) augmented with government API integrations. This aligns with:

- QDB One established NAS integration pattern (ADR-002)
- QDB One established MOCI integration pattern (architecture.md, C4 Level 1)
- ConnectSW standard document storage patterns

Integration Complexity Assessment:

Integration	Complexity	Why
NAS/Tawtheeq	Medium	OIDC/SAML is standardised; QDB One has done this; requires NAS sandbox access and production onboarding
MOCI CR API	Medium	REST/SOAP API exists (used by QDB One); requires API key/credentials and SLA confirmation
WPS Integration	High	WPS API may not be publicly documented; data sharing agreement required; integration format unknown
Dynamics CRM	Medium	Dynamics 365 Web API is well-documented; requires Azure AD service principal provisioning
Document Storage	Low	Standard object storage integration; well-understood patterns
NRGP List Lookup	Low	Load list into PostgreSQL; query by CR number; simple lookup

Overall Technical Complexity: Moderate — the portal itself is a standard CRUD application with a well-defined workflow. The complexity is concentrated in the external integrations, particularly WPS, and the security requirements around government data handling.

Technical Risks:

- WPS integration may not be achievable in the target timeframe if an MOU does not exist
- NAS sandbox environment availability during development
- Dynamics CRM schema customisation may require QDB IT change management cycle

10.2 Market Feasibility

Demand Evidence: Strong. The geopolitical situation is ongoing; SME cash flow stress is documented and real; NRGP is an approved program awaiting operationalisation; QDB has a policy mandate to execute.

Timing: Critical. The longer delivery takes, the more SMEs pass the point of no return (WPS violations, lease defaults, closure). A 6–8 week delivery target is aggressive but achievable for a focused MVP.

Go-to-Market Barriers:

- SME awareness of the portal (requires QDB communications campaign)

- SME readiness to use Tawtheeq (if significant % lack accounts — see ASM-007)
- Language accessibility (Arabic UI is essential for some SME populations)

10.3 Resource Feasibility

Estimated Agent Effort:

Role	Estimated Effort	Notes
Product Manager	2 sprints	Spec, acceptance criteria, backlog
Architect	1 sprint	Integration contracts, ADRs
Backend Engineer	4 sprints	API, eligibility engine, integrations, CRM connector
Frontend Engineer	3 sprints	Portal UI (bilingual), document upload, status display
Data Engineer	1 sprint	NRGP list loader, audit schema, document storage
QA Engineer	2 sprints (parallel)	Test coverage, integration testing
Security Engineer	1 sprint	Auth flow review, document security, PDPA compliance
DevOps Engineer	1 sprint	CI/CD, hosting, secrets management

Total Estimated Effort: 15 sprints (parallel execution = ~6–8 calendar weeks with a team of 4–5 agents working concurrently)

Infrastructure:

- Hosting: On-premise at QDB (consistent with AP-7 data sovereignty) or Qatar-based cloud
- Document storage: Encrypted object storage, Qatar-resident
- Dynamics CRM: Existing QDB infrastructure; no new procurement
- NAS: Government API — no infrastructure cost

Third-Party Dependencies:

- NAS API access (government onboarding process)
- MOCI API credentials (government process)
- WPS data sharing agreement (requires legal/MOU process)
- Dynamics CRM API access (internal IT)

10.4 Feasibility Summary

Dimension	Rating	Confidence	Key Risk
Technical	High	Medium	WPS integration timeline and API availability unknown
Market	High	High	Clear demand, approved program, immediate business need
Resource	Medium	High	Timeline is aggressive; WPS and NAS onboarding may extend it

11. Success Metrics

11.1 Key Performance Indicators

KPI	Baseline	Target	Measurement	Frequency
Application processing time (auto-disbursement path)	N/A (no portal)	<1 business day from submission to CRM case creation	Portal timestamp logs	Daily
Application processing time (manual review path)	15–30 business days	<5 business days from submission to QDB decision	CRM case timestamps	Daily
Document re-submission rate	40–60% (manual)	<10%	Portal upload success/failure logs	Weekly
Eligible applications processed per week	~20 (manual capacity)	500+ (digital capacity)	Portal application logs	Weekly
NAS authentication success rate	N/A	>98%	Auth service logs	Daily
MOCI API success rate	N/A	>99.5%	API monitoring	Daily
WPS validation completion rate	N/A	>95% of submitted applications	WPS integration logs	Daily
CRM case creation failure rate	N/A	<0.1%	CRM integration logs	Daily
Applicant satisfaction score (post-application survey)	N/A	>4.0/5.0	In-portal survey	Ongoing
Portal uptime during business hours	N/A	>99.5%	Infrastructure monitoring	Continuous
Duplicate application detection rate	N/A (no control)	100% (zero duplicate CRM cases per CR per period)	CR-level dedup logs	Daily
Audit trail completeness	N/A	100% (every application step logged)	Audit log completeness check	Daily

11.2 Success Criteria

The QDB SME Relief Portal is considered successful when:

1. **Operational**: The portal processes its first 100 applications end-to-end (authentication through CRM case creation) with zero manual QDB operations intervention for eligible, complete applications.

2. **Speed**: Average end-to-end processing time for auto-disbursement path is under 24 hours from application submission.
3. **Scale**: Portal handles peak load of 200 simultaneous sessions without response time degradation beyond 3 seconds per page.
4. **Completeness**: 100% of submitted applications have a structured audit trail entry for every process step.
5. **Accuracy**: Zero NRGP list check errors (confirmed against ground-truth list) in first 30 days of operation.
6. **Fraud Control**: Zero duplicate CRM cases created for the same CR number in the same relief period.

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12. Risk Register

ID	Risk	Probability	Impact	Score	Mitigation	Owner
RSK-001	WPS integration cannot be established within delivery timeline due to missing MOU or API unavailability	High	High	9	Begin MOU process in Sprint 0 in parallel with development; design portal to function without WPS (manual salary document review as fallback); clearly communicate WPS validation as a "Planned" feature	Architect + QDB Legal
RSK-002	NAS/Tawtheeq sandbox environment is unavailable during development, blocking auth integration	Medium	High	6	Request NAS sandbox access in Sprint 0; use mock OIDC server (e.g., Keycloak local) during development; QDB One ADR-002 patterns provide a blueprint to accelerate	Backend Engineer
RSK-003	MOCI API does not return authorized signatory / shareholder data, making authorization check impossible	Medium	High	6	Design authorization check as a declaration (applicant affirms they are authorized) with post-submission verification by QDB if MOCI data is insufficient; document limitation in audit trail	Architect

ID	Risk	Probability	Impact	Score	Mitigation	Owner
RSK-004	Dynamics CRM schema requires significant customization that is blocked by QDB IT change management	Medium	High	6	Engage QDB IT from Sprint 0; identify existing CRM entities that can be reused; have a fallback of email-based case notification with manual CRM entry as a degraded mode	DevOps + QDB IT
RSK-005	A significant percentage of SME owners do not have Tawtheeq accounts, creating an authentication gap	Medium	Medium	4	Survey sample of target audience in Sprint 0; if >20% lack accounts, design a QDB-assisted onboarding path (RM-assisted Tawtheeq registration) or a QDB temporary credential for those in transition	Product Manager
RSK-006	NRGP beneficiary list is in an unstructured format (PDF, spreadsheet) and requires significant cleansing before it can power automated lookup	Low	High	6	Request list from QDB Operations in Sprint 0; allocate Data Engineer time for cleansing and loading; set a "list ready" milestone as a prerequisite for NRGP check feature	Data Engineer
RSK-007	Eligibility criteria are not formally documented or agreed, causing implementation rework mid-sprint	High	Medium	6	Make eligibility criteria sign-off a Sprint 0 exit gate; no eligibility engine code written until criteria are signed off by Credit Risk and Compliance	Product Manager + QDB
RSK-008	The portal experiences a fraud wave in the first days after launch,	Medium	High	6	MOCI and NAS integration already provides strong identity anchors; WPS	Security Engineer

ID	Risk	Probability	Impact	Score	Mitigation	Owner
	with ineligible companies submitting false impact evidence				reduces salary over-claiming; add rate limiting per CR; monitor for outlier application patterns in first 72 hours	
RSK-009	Document storage or audit logging fails silently, producing incomplete records that invalidate the NRGP program audit	Low	Critical	7	Implement write-ahead logging for audit entries; use transactional writes for document storage; alert on any audit log gap; run daily completeness checks	Backend Engineer + DevOps
RSK-010	The portal remains open past the intended program end date due to manual oversight, creating unauthorized applications and QDB liability	Low	Medium	3	Implement hard-coded program end date with automated sunset; QDB Compliance Officer notified 14 days before close; portal enters read-only mode after close	DevOps + QDB Ops
RSK-011	Arabic UI translation quality is poor, causing confusion among Arabic-speaking SME owners	Low	Medium	3	Use professional legal/financial Arabic translation (not machine translation); conduct Arabic usability test with 3–5 native speakers before launch	UI/UX Designer + QDB Comms
RSK-012	PDPA (Qatar Personal Data Protection Act) compliance issues with document storage or WPS data handling	Medium	High	6	Engage QDB Legal / Data Protection Officer in Sprint 0; data classification for all stored fields; encryption at rest confirmed; access control audit; PDPA	Security Engineer + QDB Legal

ID	Risk	Probability	Impact	Score	Mitigation	Owner
					impact assessment documented	

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13. Recommendations

13.1 Go/No-Go Recommendation

Recommendation: GO — proceed to product specification immediately.

Evidence:

- Business need is clear, urgent, and quantifiable (SME cash flow stress with WPS fine exposure)
- An approved government program (NRGP) is waiting for digital operationalisation
- QDB has existing relationships with NAS and MOCI (established in QDB One)
- The technical architecture is well-understood; no novel technical risk
- The only material blocker (WPS integration) has a defined fallback path
- The cost of inaction — SME defaults, WPS violations, business closures — exceeds the cost and risk of rapid delivery

Conditions:

1. Eligibility criteria must be formally signed off before Sprint 1 begins (RSK-007)
2. WPS MOU/API investigation must begin immediately in Sprint 0 (RSK-001)
3. NAS sandbox access must be confirmed within 1 week of project start (RSK-002)
4. NRGP beneficiary list must be obtained and assessed within 1 week of project start (RSK-006)

13.2 Prioritized Action Items

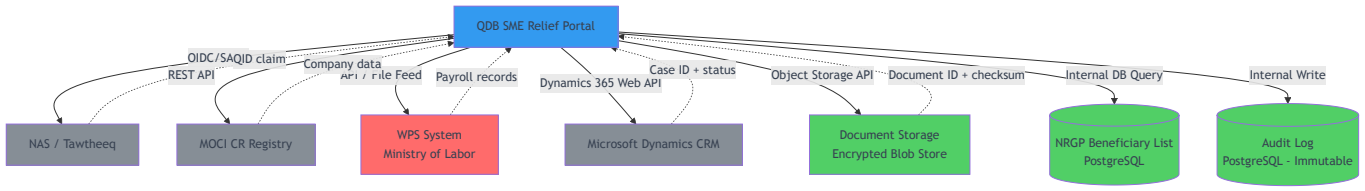
1. **Sprint 0 (Week 1)**: Technical discovery on all four integrations (NAS, MOCI, WPS, Dynamics CRM); obtain NRGP beneficiary list; get eligibility criteria sign-off; confirm data sharing legal basis for WPS; assign QDB IT liaison.
2. **Sprint 1 (Weeks 2–3)**: Build NAS authentication, MOCI CR lookup, eligibility engine (based on signed-off criteria); skeleton CRM integration; bilingual UI scaffold.
3. **Sprint 2 (Weeks 4–5)**: Document upload, storage, and validation; NRGP list check; CRM auto vs. manual routing; WPS integration (or document-based fallback if WPS not ready); audit trail.
4. **Sprint 3 (Week 6)**: Status display, notifications, management dashboard, duplicate detection; full integration test with QDB IT; UAT with QDB operations staff.
5. **Sprint 4 (Weeks 7–8)**: Security audit, load testing, Arabic translation review, PDPA compliance check, deployment to QDB production environment; QDB staff training; communications campaign coordination.
6. **Post-launch (Ongoing)**: Daily audit log completeness monitoring; 72-hour fraud watch; weekly KPI reporting to QDB board; program end-date notification and graceful sunset.

13.3 Business Need to User Story Mapping (PM Handoff)

Business Need	Suggested User Stories	Priority
BN-001: NAS Authentication	US-01: As an SME owner, I want to log in with my Tawtheeq account so that I do not need to create a new credential to access the relief portal. US-02: As a system, I must redirect unauthenticated users to NAS login and process the returned QID claim to establish a portal session.	P0
BN-002: MOCI CR Lookup	US-03: As an SME owner, I want to enter my CR number and have the system retrieve my verified company details from MOCI so that I do not need to manually enter company information. US-04: As a system, I must verify that the authenticated NAS identity matches an authorized signatory for the CR number provided.	P0
BN-003: Eligibility Check	US-05: As an SME owner, I want to know immediately whether my company is eligible for NRGP relief so that I do not waste time submitting documents for an ineligible application. US-06: As a system, I must evaluate eligibility against all defined NRGP criteria and provide a clear result with reasons for ineligibility.	P0
BN-004: Auto Disbursement (NRGP listed)	US-07: As a QDB operations officer, I want auto-disbursement cases to be created in Dynamics CRM for eligible NRGP-listed companies without my manual intervention so that I can focus on new applicant reviews.	P0
BN-005: Manual Review (not NRGP listed)	US-08: As a QDB relationship manager, I want manual review cases to arrive in Dynamics CRM with all application data and documents pre-populated so that I can make a decision without contacting the applicant for basic information.	P0
BN-006: Document Upload	US-09: As an SME owner, I want to upload salary evidence, rent evidence, and company documents through the portal so that I have a single structured submission process. US-10: As a system, I must validate document format, size, and completeness at upload time and provide actionable error messages for any failures.	P0
BN-007: WPS Validation	US-11: As a QDB credit officer, I want the portal to validate stated salary obligations against WPS data so that relief amounts are anchored to government-verified payroll records. US-12: As a system, I must flag WPS discrepancies >10% on the CRM case for manual review without blocking the application.	P0
BN-008: Audit Trail	US-13: As a QDB compliance officer, I want every application step, decision, and data source to be logged in a tamper-evident audit record so that the NRGP program can be audited by government authorities.	P0

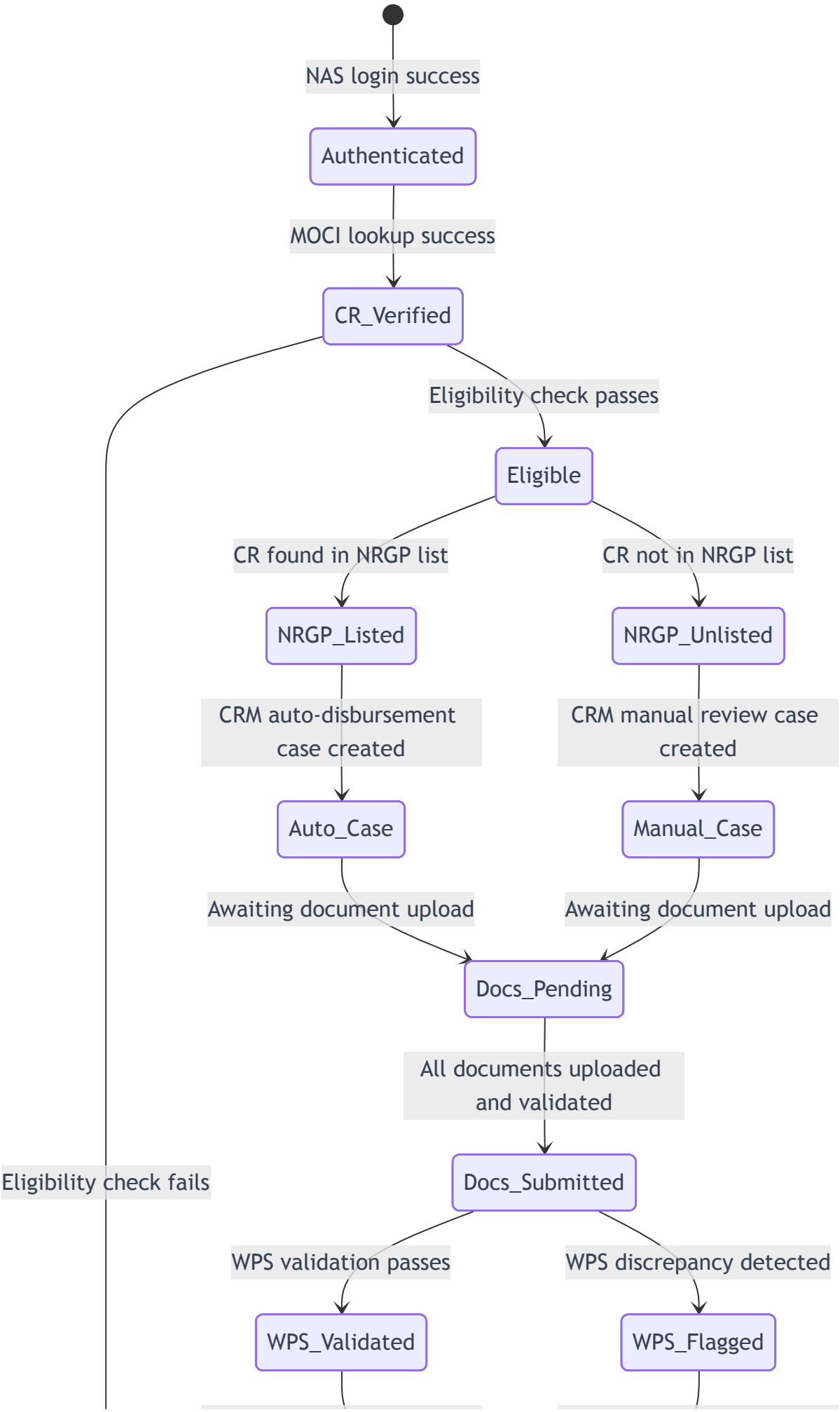
Business Need	Suggested User Stories	Priority
BN-009: Application Status Visibility	US-14: As an SME owner, I want to see my current application status in the portal so that I do not need to call QDB to ask about my case.	P1
BN-010: Bilingual UI	US-15: As an Arabic-speaking SME owner, I want to use the portal entirely in Arabic so that language is not a barrier to accessing relief funding.	P1
BN-011: Document Validation	Covered by US-10 above.	P0
BN-012: Notifications	US-16: As an SME owner, I want to receive email and/or SMS notifications when my application status changes so that I am informed without having to poll the portal.	P1
BN-013: Management Dashboard	US-17: As a QDB operations manager, I want a dashboard showing application volumes, statuses, and processing times so that I can manage team capacity and report program progress to the board.	P1
BN-014: Load Handling	US-18: As a system, I must handle 200 concurrent sessions during a launch surge without response time exceeding 3 seconds per page load.	P1
BN-015: Program Lifecycle	US-19: As a QDB program administrator, I want the portal to automatically stop accepting new applications after the program end date and display a clear message to applicants who try to apply after close.	P2
BN-016: Configurable Criteria	US-20: As a QDB credit risk officer, I want to update eligibility criteria through an admin interface without requiring a code deployment so that policy changes can be reflected same-day.	P2
BN-017: Duplicate Detection	US-21: As a system, I must detect and reject duplicate applications from the same CR number within the same relief period, displaying a clear message to the applicant with their existing case reference.	P2
BN-018: Document Security	US-22: As a QDB data protection officer, I want uploaded documents to be encrypted at rest and accessible only to the applicant and authorized QDB staff so that PDPA obligations are met.	P1

Appendix A: Integration Dependency Map



Note: WPS is highlighted as high-risk (red) due to uncertain API availability and MOU dependency.

Appendix B: NRGP Process State Diagram


NAS login success
Authenticated
MOCI lookup success
CR_Verified
Eligibility check passes
Eligible
CR found in NRGP list
CR not in NRGP list
NRGP_Listed
NRGP_Unlisted
CRM auto-disbursement case created
CRM manual review case created
Auto_Case
Manual_Case
Awaiting document upload
Awaiting document upload
Docs_Pending
All documents uploaded and validated
Eligibility check fails
Docs_Submitted
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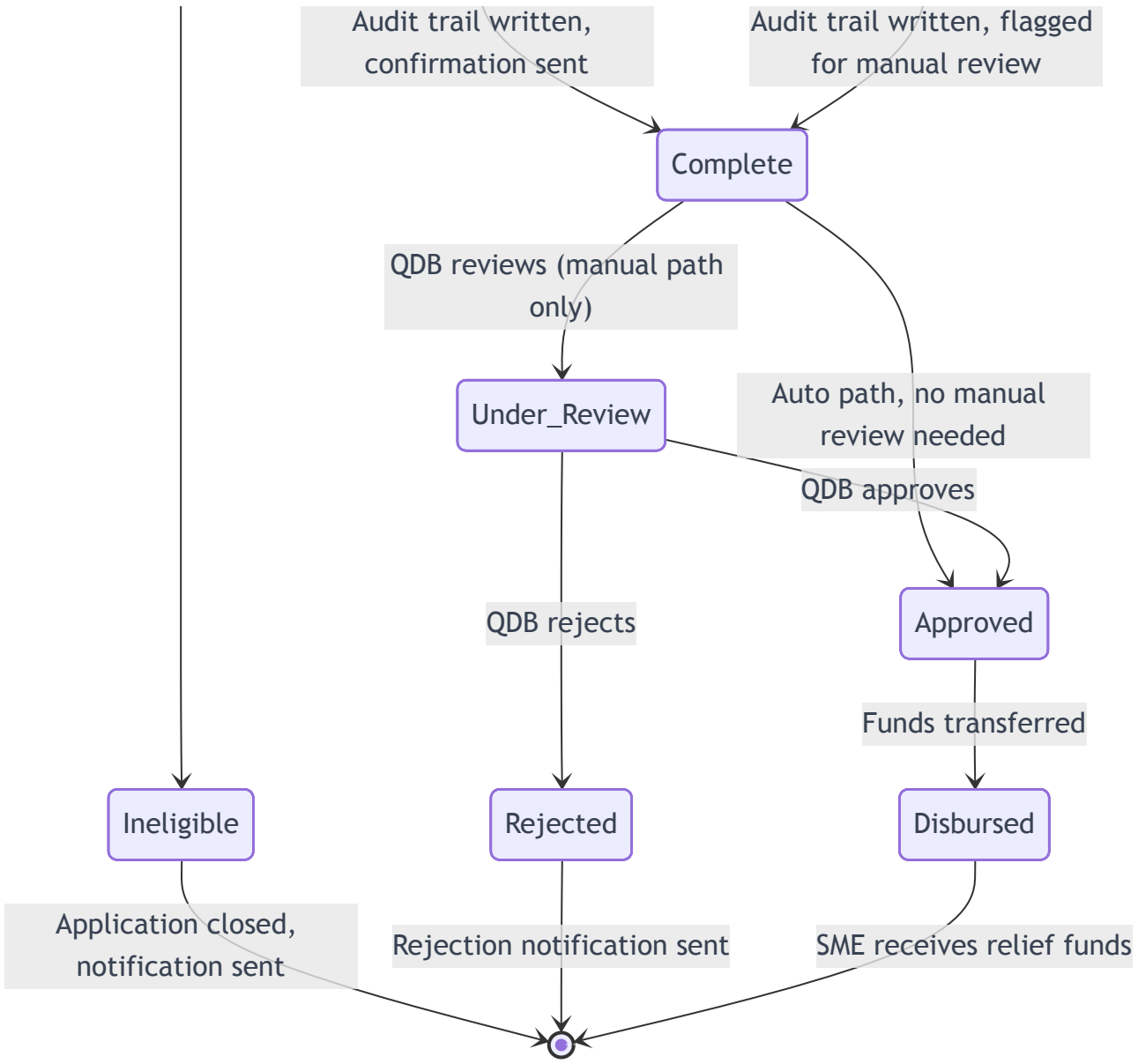
WPS_Flagged



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